

Proposal for 49881 - Start Up Creation in Practice

49-881 - Course Description:

Similar to an independent study, but focused specifically on new venture creation, students will work on developing their technology-focused idea into a potentially viable company through this course. Students can work individually or through a team with other MSSM students. Each student (team) must have their proposal approved before being approved for enrollment into the course.

Start-Up Creation Proposal Process

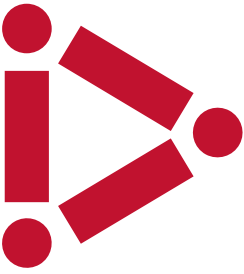
Students who are interested in enrolling into 49881 - Start-Up Creation in Practice must follow the process outlined below and use this form to submit their course proposal.

Step 1: Consult with Sheryl Root & other supervising faculty (as needed) on their project of interest. After verbal support for the project has been given, students must put together a formal proposal using this template form.

Step 2: After your proposal is complete, students must submit their proposal as a PDF through the online [Start-Up Creation in Practice Submission form](#). Please make sure that your proposals are complete and that no information is missing.

Step 3: Once your proposal has been reviewed, you will receive an email notification from Leia Delabahan confirming whether your proposal needs additional updates or has been approved as is. Once your proposal has been approved, you will automatically be registered into 49881 - Start-Up Creation in Practice.

Student Information



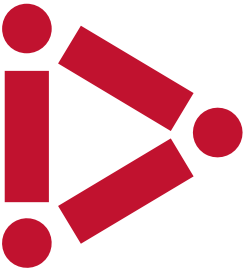
Name	Xiangchen Kong	Date	08/07/2026
Andrew ID	xk		
Semester & Year	Fall 2026		

Start Up Information

Subject Area	Consumer AI / e-commerce: sizing and fit intelligence.
Topic/Problem Area	Fit Passport gives shoppers one fit profile they can reuse across brands and retailers. It learns from body info, clothes that fit well, and keep/return feedback. Human apparel is the MVP, with pet sizing as a small extension.
Other Team Members (if applicable)	Alyssa Qi
Persona	Primary: frequent online shoppers, roughly ages 18-40, who buy across brands and often second-guess sizing. Secondary: dog/cat owners buying size-dependent apparel, harnesses, or accessories.
Market & Segment	Beachhead: U.S. online apparel shoppers. Adjacent markets include footwear, jewelry, and pet gear; the global virtual fitting-room market is estimated at \$8.5B in 2026 and pet clothing at \$2.3B.

Course Plan

Objective & Expected Outcome <i>To include potential business model (using the canvas)</i>	Build and validate a web MVP where users create a Fit Passport, add known-good items, paste a product URL, get a size recommendation with an explanation, and record keep/return results. Test a small dog/cat profile as an extension. Business model: freemium B2C first, with affiliate and API options later.	
Hypotheses & Methodology	H1: cross-brand sizing creates real shopping friction. H2: known-good items and fit preferences improve recommendations over generic size charts. H3: keep/return feedback improves later recommendations. H4: the same profile model may extend to pets. Test through 20-25 shopper interviews, 3-5 pet-owner interviews, Figma tests, and a 10-15 user beta.	
Milestones & Deliverables By Week <i>To be reviewed by Faculty Advisor</i>	W1	Problem framing, competitor research, interview guide, and success metrics.
	W2	Conduct first 8-10 online-shopper interviews.
	W3	Finish interviews/survey; 3-5 pet-owner interviews; build personas.
	W4	Synthesize findings, Value Proposition, BMC v1, and lock MVP scope.
	W5	Build Figma prototype and run 8-10 usability tests.
	W6	Technical spike: parse product pages, size charts, and fit information.
	W7	Define Fit Passport data model and build web-app foundation.
	W8	Build core MVP: profile, known-good items, URL import, and fit history.



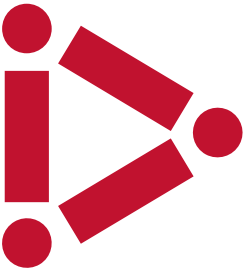
	W9	Build size recommendation engine with confidence and explanations.
	W10	Add keep/return/exchange feedback and fit-learning loop.
	W11	Add regional sizing and a small pet-profile prototype; VTO if time.
	W12	Integrated alpha, QA, privacy review, analytics, and beta prep.
	W13	Run beta with about 10-15 target users.
	W14	Analyze results, improve MVP, and update Business Model Canvas.
	W15	Finalize demo, findings, roadmap, BMC v2, and final report.
Potential Resource Needs <i>Faculty contacts, campus resources, Readings/texts/media/ research papers, etc</i>		Faculty feedback; shopper and pet-owner interviewees; retailer product pages/size charts; LLM/VLM APIs; cloud hosting/database; Figma; analytics tools; optional VTO API.

Required Final Deliverable

10-page (minimum) **Reflection Essay** to be completed near the end of the course semester. There are two components to include:

1. Summarize your findings and/or outcomes (~80% of paper)
 - a. Include Business Canvas as appropriate
 - b. Detail interviews or research that resulted in key findings
2. Discuss your experience from a self-study/research process perspective (~20% of paper)
 - a. How well did the chosen approach work?
 - b. What were your challenges, and how did you over come them?
 - c. What would you do differently if you were to compelte this course again?
 - d. What advice do you have for students who wish to be successful with the start up course?

Required Signatures



Student: Xiangchen Kong Date: 08/07/2026
Signature confirms commitment to meet deliverable deadlines and meet with Supervising Faculty weekly

Course Instructor: _____ Date: _____
Signature confirms approval of course plan

